

Context Handoff Package

Spoon-fed install guide for your architect

Long AI sessions lose context when the window compacts or you start a new chat. This package installs rules and hooks so the agent saves a small handoff (<=400 tokens) and the next session can resume without rework.

Fastest path (recommended)

- 1. Open tools/context-handoff-package/PROMPT.md in the repo.
- 2. Copy everything below the horizontal rule line in PROMPT.md.
- 3. Paste into your AI tool (Cursor, VS Code Copilot, Windsurf, or Devin) and send.
- 4. Let the agent run the installer and report the checklist back.

Or run two commands (repo root)

```
bash tools/context-handoff-package/install.sh --all
bash tools/context-handoff-package/verify.sh
```

Install one tool only

```
bash tools/context-handoff-package/install.sh --cursor
bash tools/context-handoff-package/install.sh --vscode
bash tools/context-handoff-package/install.sh --windsurf
bash tools/context-handoff-package/install.sh --devin
```

What gets installed

Tool	Handoff file	How it triggers
Cursor	.cursor/handoff/STATE.md	Hooks in .cursor/hooks.json
VS Code	.github/handoff/STATE.md	Copilot hooks (.github/hooks/)
Windsurf	.windsurf/handoff/STATE.md	Rule (agent writes on thresholds)
Devin	.devin/handoff/STATE.md	Rule (agent writes on thresholds)

All tools also use .session-logs/LAST_SESSION_BRIEF.md (shared brief).

Complexity tiers

Tier	Signals	Trigger	Refresh
Low	<=5 tools, <=2 paths, no subagents	65%	preCompact only
Medium	Default session	60%	preCompact + scope change
High	>=15 tools or >=5 paths or multi-file	52%	+12% or scope change
Critical	Subagents or >=25 tools	45%	+10%, subagent, or scope

Handoff content (agent enriches)

Keep both STATE and LAST_SESSION_BRIEF under 400 tokens total combined.

- Active task - one sentence
- Progress - done vs still open
- Files touched - paths only, no file contents
- Next step - single highest-priority action

Context Handoff - Install Instructions

- Blockers - only if present

Never include: secrets, tokens, env values, API responses, or code dumps.

Cursor hooks (automated)

Event	Script	Behavior
afterAgentResponse	context-handoff.py	Write/refresh when threshold crossed
stop	context-handoff.py	Same on agent stop
preCompact	context-handoff.py	Always write before compaction
subagentStop	context-handoff.py	Refresh after subagents (critical tier)
sessionStart	session-start-handoff.py	Inject saved handoff on new session

VS Code hooks (GitHub Copilot)

Prerequisites: Agent hooks are preview. Org must allow hooks. Confirm chat.hookFilesLocations includes .github/hooks. For monorepo subfolders, enable chat.useCustomizationsInParentRepositories.

Event	Script	Behavior
SessionStart	session-start-handoff.py	Inject saved handoff
PreCompact	context-handoff.py	Always write before compaction
Stop	context-handoff.py	Write/refresh when threshold crossed
SubagentStop	context-handoff.py	Refresh after subagents
PostToolUse	context-handoff.py	Check threshold after each tool

Package files

- PROMPT.md - paste into AI tool
- README.md - full docs and troubleshooting
- COPY_PASTE_FOR_ARCHITECT.md - email/Slack blurb
- install.sh - one-command installer
- verify.sh - post-install checks

Troubleshooting

Problem	Fix
verify.sh fails	Re-run: install.sh --all
Cursor hooks not firing	Enable hooks in Cursor Settings; chmod +x scripts
VS Code hooks not firing	Check org policy; Copilot Chat Hooks output channel
Wrong repo path	install.sh --all /path/to/repo
Duplicate hook entries	Safe to re-run - merge scripts skip duplicates

Done when

- verify.sh prints "All checks passed."
- Do not commit STATE.md, LAST_SESSION_BRIEF.md, or .triggered-* (in .gitignore)
- Architect replies with PROMPT Step 5 checklist

Copy to another repo

Copy the entire tools/context-handoff-package/ folder into the target repo, then run `install.sh --all` or paste `PROMPT.md` into the AI tool.